JAMES CHRISTOPHER HARTLEY

Staff Engineer

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LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jameschartley

GitHub: github.com/jchartley

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES:

- github.com/jchartley/distributed-cache-engine
- github.com/jchartley/kubernetes-multi-region-orchestrator
- github.com/jchartley/postgresql-query-optimizer
- github.com/jchartley/microservices-monitoring-toolkit

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years of experience building scalable distributed systems and leading technical initiatives across multiple organizations. I've spent the last decade working on high-throughput infrastructure at scale, mentoring engineering teams, and making architectural decisions that have impacted millions of users. I have a deep focus on reliability, performance optimization, and establishing strong engineering practices across large codebases.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

DataVault Solutions - Birmingham, United Kingdom

www.datavaultsolutions.co

October 2021 - Present

Designed and implemented a distributed caching layer that reduced database load by 65% and improved API response times from 800ms to 120ms for 2.3 million daily active users.

Led the migration of our monolithic payment processing system to microservices, establishing patterns and standards adopted across 8 engineering teams.

Mentored 6 junior and mid-level engineers on system design, code review practices, and production debugging through weekly one-on-ones and technical workshops.

Established on-call runbooks and incident response procedures that reduced mean time to recovery from 45 minutes to 12 minutes across our platform.

Senior Software Engineer

Nexus Platform Ltd - Birmingham, United Kingdom

nexus-platform.io

March 2018 - September 2021

Built a real-time event streaming platform using Apache Kafka processing 2 billion messages daily, serving analytics and reporting pipelines for enterprise clients.

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and indexing strategies across legacy systems, reducing query execution times by 70% and cutting database infrastructure costs by 40%.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, catching production issues before customer impact in 78% of cases.

Conducted architecture reviews for 15 major projects, identifying scalability risks and recommending solutions that prevented outages and technical debt accumulation.

Software Engineer

Catalyst Digital Group - Manchester, United Kingdom

www.catalystdigital.com

June 2010 - February 2018

Developed backend services for a content delivery platform handling 500 million requests monthly using Java, Go, and Python across multiple AWS regions.

Reduced deployment time from 2 hours to 8 minutes by building automated CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and containerizing applications with Docker.

Participated in on-call rotations and resolved critical production incidents, including a database failover affecting 50,000 concurrent users, implementing fixes within 30 minutes.

Collaborated with frontend and DevOps teams to establish API contracts and deployment standards that improved development velocity and reduced integration bugs by 45%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

2006 - 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash, JavaScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, Cassandra

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudFormation), Google Cloud Platform

Distributed Systems: Kafka, RabbitMQ, gRPC, Event-driven architectures

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Helm

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Jaeger, DataDog

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD

Architecture: Microservices, event-driven systems, CQRS, domain-driven design, API design

Operating Systems: Linux, macOS, Windows Server

Tools: Git, Terraform, Ansible, Apache Kafka, nginx